

TRIBAL INDIA — L-62 CLASS NOTES

Paper 2 | Chapter 6.3 | Handout 3

Sarrthi IAS — Anthropology Foundation (Nataraj Sir)

Displacement & R&R

Forest Policies

FRA 2006

Climate & TEK

Industrialization

Urbanization

 = Handwritten class annotations included & marked with 

Comprehensive Exam-Ready Notes — UPSC CSE 2026

1. DEVELOPMENTAL PROJECTS & TRIBAL DISPLACEMENT

DISPLACEMENT OF TRIBALS

- **Causes:** Dams, Mining, Nuclear plants, Hydro-electric projects
- **Scale:** 50M displaced; 40-50% are tribals (8.6% of population)
- **Impacts:** Livelihood → Socio-cultural → Economic → Psychological
- **Measures:** NRRP 2007, FRA 2006, PESA 1996

 **HANDWRITTEN**

Michael Cernea

Involuntary displacement should be **minimized**, if possible **avoided**. If inevitable, **livelihood must be protected**. R&R should be "**people centric**" in approach.

 **HANDWRITTEN**

Nalini Negi & Sutapa Ganguly

Study for University of Bielefeld, Germany (2011): ~**50 million people** displaced in India due to development projects — of which **40-50% are tribals**.

Key Stat: Tribal population = **8.6%** of India, but projects displaced **over 50%** of tribals — showing **disproportionate impact**.

1.1 Dam-Induced Displacement — Case Studies

Polavaram Dam

Andhra Pradesh

Estimated displacement of **3 lakh people**; majority are tribals.

Sardar Sarovar Dam (Narmada)

Gujarat / MP / Maharashtra

12 Dec 1979: Govt raised dam height. 30 major + 135 medium + 3000 small dams. **2,00,000 displaced**, majority Adivasis. Water to 40M people.

1.2 Mining-Induced Displacement — Case Studies

Pakri Barwadih Coal Mining Project

Hazaribagh District, Jharkhand | NTPC | North Karanpura Coalfield

- Land acquisition since **2016**: 3,319.42 ha (1,950.5 ha farmland + 643.9 ha forest + 101.22 ha settlements)
- **19 villages** face displacement (Barkagaon, Sonbarsa, Pakri Barwadih, Deoria Khurd)
- Compensation: Rs 9.85-10.85 lakh/adult — but re-employed as **contract guards/labourers** on their own land
- Women's factory jobs ended abruptly; families left jobless
- Mining companies acquired **87,000+ ha** in Jharkhand (larger than Bengaluru)
- Jharkhand's 2008 R&R Policy promised local benefit — reality: **tribals lost land + livelihood**

Chaal Coal Mine

Raigarh District, Chhattisgarh | SECL | Since 2003

- Displaced ~**400 Kavar tribe families** from Lath village (only 56 left)
- Blasting destroyed farmlands & rice fields → **forced migration**
- Mine waste → **water contamination** → lost clean water & fish
- Rehabilitation promises remained **on paper only**
- Hindalco Industries demolished Adivasi homes without consent/compensation nearby
- Result: **land alienation + livelihood loss + erosion of tribal dignity**

1.3 Impacts of Displacement

DIMENSION	KEY IMPACTS
Livelihood	Loss of forest access & natural habitat; pushed to fringes with no forest produce
Socio-Cultural	Collectiveness → individualism; agriculturalists → industrial labour; ritualistic cultures fading; endogamy → exogamy
Economic	Loss of forest produce; become landless peasants; severe poverty; shift to industrial labour; inadequate & delayed monetary compensation
Psychological	Insecurity, helplessness, identity crisis (covered in detail under industrialization section)

1.4 Measures — National R&R Policy, 2007

OBJECTIVE
Minimize displacement; promote non-displacing / least-displacing alternatives
Ensure adequate R&R package with active participation of affected families
Special care for SCs, STs, weaker sections — treated with concern & sensitivity
Provide better standard of living & sustainable income to affected families
Integrate rehabilitation into development planning & implementation
Facilitate harmonious relationship through mutual cooperation (land acquisition cases)

Conclusion: Displacement has always been a companion of development. The process should be **humane & voluntary**. Focus must be on **rehabilitation, not just displacement**. Cost of rehabilitation should be included in project cost.

2. FOREST POLICIES & TRIBALS

FOREST POLICY EVOLUTION

- **Colonial Era:** Control & exploitation (1865 → 1878 → 1894 → 1927)
- **Post-Independence:** Gradual recognition (1952 → 1980 → 1982 → 1988)
- **Rights Era:** Community governance (FRA 2006)
- **Shift:** Coercive control → Participatory conservation

2.1 Tribal-Forest Relationship

 **HANDWRITTEN**

Tripathi (2016)

Tribes live in a "*harmonious and interdependent relationship*" with their forest environment. Their economic life, social organisation, and magico-religious beliefs all revolve around the forest ecosystem.

Tribal-forest relationship is **symbiotic** — forests provide food, shelter, fuel, livelihood, and cultural identity.

2.2 Colonial Period Forest Acts

ACT / POLICY	KEY PROVISIONS
Forest Act, 1865	Beginning of formal state control; traditional practices restricted by law; forests = state property
Forest Act, 1878	Divided forests into Reserved, Protected & Village ; trespassing/grazing/collecting = offences; Forest Dept power consolidated
First Forest Policy, 1894	Introduced " Eminent Domain " (state has ultimate control); "Rights of individuals must be limited"; focused on revenue & timber for British
Indian Forest Act, 1927	Codified all previous forest laws; strengthened forest officers' power; Section 64 : arrest without warrant; continued colonial legacy of exclusion & exploitation

Colonial Logic: Forest laws had little to do with conservation — created to serve British **timber needs**. Overrode customary rights, declared forests as **state property**. Destroyed community management systems, forcing people to either abandon forests or live as "**criminals**".

2.3 Post-Independence Forest Policies

POLICY / COMMITTEE	KEY POINTS
National Forest Policy, 1952	Continued colonial approach; limited tribal rights recognition ; forests = national asset; tribals given concessions, not rights
Natl Committee on Dev of Backward Areas (1980)	Recommended tribal rights & concessions be fully protected ; domestic needs met through forest produce
B.K. Roy Burman Committee (1982)	Tribes earn ~1/3 income from minor forest produce ; positive role of forest dwellers in preservation; integrate tribal participation in forest management
National Forest Policy, 1988	Paradigm shift: revenue-oriented → people-oriented forest management Objective: environmental stability & ecological balance Recognised symbiotic relationship of tribals with forests Tribal communities to be actively involved in forest protection  (Hiremath, 1994) Introduced Joint Forest Management (JFM) MFP recognised as a right (not concession) → led to TRIFED

2.4 Transition: Colonial → Community Governance

TRANSITION DIMENSION	FROM → TO
Control to Custodianship	State power & revenue extraction (1865-1927) → tribal custodianship (post-1988, 2006)
Management Model	Top-down bureaucracy → Gram Sabhas as democratic forest managers (FRA 2006)
Philosophy	Extractive forestry → rights-based environmental justice
Purpose	Economic utility → ecological balance & JFM / CFR
Persisting Gap	MoTA vs MoEFCC conflicts; conservation vs livelihood priorities still unresolved

3. FOREST RIGHTS ACT (FRA), 2006 — Detailed

FRA 2006

- **Purpose:** Undo historical injustice to forest-dwelling communities
- **3 Types of Rights:** Land | Use | Community (Protect & Conserve)
- **Central Authority:** Gram Sabhas
- **Special Provision:** PVTGs — habitat & habitation rights [S. 3(1)(e)]
- **Linked Laws:** PESA 1996, FCA 1980, WLPA 1972

3.1 Objectives of FRA 2006

- Undo **historical injustice** to forest-dwelling communities
- Ensure **land tenure, livelihood & food security** for forest-dwelling STs & OTFDs
- Strengthen conservation by including **sustainable use, biodiversity conservation & ecological balance**

3.2 Who Is Eligible?

STAGE	CONDITIONS
Stage 1 (Both)	1. Primarily residing in forests/forest lands 2. Depend on forests for livelihood ("Bonafide livelihood needs")
Stage 2A	Above conditions true for 75 years → "Other Traditional Forest Dweller" (OTFD)
Stage 2B	Member of Scheduled Tribe + residing in Scheduled Area → "Forest Dwelling Scheduled Tribe"

3.3 Three Types of Rights

RIGHT TYPE	DETAILS
Land Rights	No rights to land not cultivated before 13 Dec 2005 & not currently cultivated. Without documents: claim up to 4 hectares (self-cultivation for livelihood only)
Use Rights	Collection of MFP (tendu, herbs, medicinal plants — no timber); grazing grounds & water bodies; traditional areas of nomadic/pastoralist communities
Community Forest Rights (CFR)	Section 3(1)(i): Community right to protect, regenerate, conserve & manage forests around villages. First time law gives community this right. CFRMCs established.
PVTG Rights	Section 3(1)(e): Special habitat & habitation rights for PVTGs in reserved/protected forests

3.4 CFR — Positive Case Studies

Chhattisgarh & Odisha: CFR Recognition

Kanger Ghati NP (CG) & Simlipal NP (Odisha)

CG recognised ~**4,000 CFRs**. Kanger Ghati = 2nd national park (after Simlipal) with recognised CFR. Gudiypadar communities allowed to reside inside park with **community-led regulations**. Balance between conservation & livelihood.

Mendha Lekha & Betakata

Maharashtra & Odisha

Formed **CFRMCs** that sustainably regulate forest use, prevent illegal felling, conserve biodiversity. Model villages for community stewardship.

3.5 CFR — Negative Case Study

Hasdeo Arand — CFR Revocation

Ghatbarra village, Chhattisgarh | Adani Enterprises

- Ghatbarra: one of first villages to get CFR titles (**810 ha in 2013**)
- DLC **revoked CFR in 2016** for mining in PEKB coal block (Adani joint venture)
- HABSS challenged in court — argued violation of Gram Sabha consent & FRA principles
- CG High Court (Oct 2025): **upheld revocation** on technical grounds, ignoring Gram Sabha evidence
- Activists: **"Mockery of FRA"** — dangerous precedent: corporate interests override community rights
- Exposes **gap between law and implementation**

3.6 Implementation Issues (14 Major Problems)

#	ISSUE	DETAILS & EXAMPLES
1	High Rejection Rates	Incomplete docs, no proof of pre-2005 cultivation; Odisha: 1.4L+ claims rejected ; genuine dwellers branded "encroachers"
2	Non-Communication	Rejections not conveyed in writing → violates Section 6(2) → no appeal within 60 days
3	Weak District Support	No revenue/forest maps to Gram Sabhas → gap between land claimed vs granted
4	Faulty Evictions	Evictions on incomplete/manipulated records (e.g. Hasdeo Arand)
5	Forest Dept Resistance	FD impedes CFR recognition; Tamil Nadu: Kattunayakans (honey collectors) harassed by forest guards
6	Conflicting Laws	FCA 1980, WLPA 1972, CAMPA 2016 conflict with FRA; 2023 FCA amendment allows ecotourism without Gram Sabha consent
7	Institutional Turf Wars	Poor coordination between MoTA & MoEFCC → contradictory directions
8	Procedural Violations	Claims rejected by Forest Guards/Patwaris (no legal authority); Chittorgarh : oral rejections, no appeal possible
9	Data Manipulation	Chhattisgarh (ATREE report) : duplicate entries; only 243 Gram Sabhas got CFR vs claimed 1,378
10	Lack of Awareness	Gram Sabha & OTFDs unaware of provisions; meetings postponed; claims delayed despite Adi Prashikshan portal
11	Judicial Uncertainty	2019 SC eviction order : panic among 1.8M forest dwellers; stayed but most states yet to review rejected claims
12	Protected Area Displacement	1 lakh+ displaced from tiger reserves (NTCA relocations) without settling FRA claims → conservation-vs-rights conflict
13	Mining Violations	Forest clearances before FRA compliance; Hasdeo Arand CFR cancellation without Gram Sabha consent
14	Uneven State Progress	CFR recognition: Maharashtra 36%, Chhattisgarh 24%, Odisha 10% ; other major states ≈ 0%

3.7 Significance & Achievements of FRA

#	ACHIEVEMENT	DETAILS
1	Historical Justice	Corrects colonial-era injustice; recognises both IFR & CFR/CFRR
2	Comprehensive Rights	Sections 3(1)(b), 3(1)(c), 3(1)(i): access, occupy, manage forest lands, water, grazing, biodiversity
3	Empowered Gram Sabhas	Central authority for claim verification & forest governance → participatory democracy
4	Community Stewardship	Mendha Lekha (MH) & Betakata (OD) : CFRMCs regulate use, prevent illegal felling
5	Economic Empowerment	Bamboo & NTFP rights raised incomes; Pajilibandha & Kalakani (Odisha) : women earn ₹5K-6K/month via Van Dhan Kendras
6	Ecological Benefits	Soura Kurlanda : restored degraded forests & increased biodiversity through community control
7	Gender & PVTG Inclusion	Women & PVTGs participate in Van Suraksha Samitis
8	Link with PESA	Odisha & MH merged FRA with PESA → Gram Sabhas get legal corporate status under Article 243G
9	Tech Innovation	Gujarat (Narmada district) : GPS & satellite imagery for digital claim mapping
10	Admin Progress	MoTA 2024: ~60% claims recognised , covering 13 million acres
11	Global Model	When implemented properly: justice-based environmental management model

3.8 Way Forward & Suggestions (12-Point)

#	SUGGESTION	DETAILS
1	Review Rejected Claims	Transparent review; written reasons; appeal rights under Section 6
2	Strengthen Gram Sabhas	Recognise as body corporates (MH & OD model) for fund management & legal representation
3	Joint Coordination	Joint MoTA-MoEFCC mechanisms for consistent policy interpretation
4	Digital Mapping	GPS & GIS mapping with BISAG & NRSC to eliminate data manipulation
5	Awareness & Training	Expand Tribal Research Institutes & Adi Prashikshan for grassroots legal training
6	Livelihood Integration	Link CFR areas with TRIFED, Van Dhan Yojana, PM-JANMAN
7	Legal Safeguards	Mandate Gram Sabha consent before mining/diversion (prevent Hasdeo-type cases)
8	Inclusive Participation	Women, PVTGs, marginal groups in decision-making & forest management
9	Monitoring & Transparency	State-level dashboards for claims data; real-time accountability
10	Model Replication	Scale Mendha Lekha & Betakata ; promote peer learning via exposure visits
11	Policy Convergence	Integrate FRA with Green India Mission, CAMPA, National Biodiversity Strategy
12	National FRA Mission	Dedicated mission with separate budget & time-bound targets (proposed in Parliament)

3.9 Supreme Court Order — Feb 2019

SC Eviction Order (13 Feb 2019)

Affecting 16 states

- SC ordered **eviction of lakhs of STs & OTFDs** whose FRA claims were rejected
- Eviction deadline: **24 July 2019**
- 28 Feb: Court **stayed its order** but warned "the mighty & undeserving" would get no mercy
- Stay due to **anthropologists & activists** raising awareness about real reasons for high rejection rates + tribal protests
- Court now examining whether **due process was followed** by Gram Sabhas & states before claim rejections

4. CLIMATE CHANGE & TRIBAL ECOLOGICAL KNOWLEDGE (TEK)

CLIMATE & TRIBALS

- **Paradox:** Strongest forest protectors ← → Severest climate impact victims
- **Risks:** Erratic monsoons, shrinking forests, soil erosion, forest fires
- **Coping:** Traditional Ecological Knowledge (TEK)
- **Path Ahead:** Integrate rights (FRA+PESA) with climate adaptation

4.1 Risks & Problems Due to Climate Change

RISK	IMPACT ON TRIBALS
Erratic Monsoons & Droughts	Threaten cultivation & forest produce; Bhil (Gujarat) : floods followed by prolonged dry spells
Shrinking Forests & Biodiversity Loss	Reduced access to MFP (tendu, mahua, bamboo) → income & food security undermined
Soil Erosion & Deforestation	Worsens migration in Central India; extreme heat & forest fires endanger crops & health

4.2 Tribal Ecological Knowledge (TEK) — Case Studies

TRIBE (LOCATION)	TEK PRACTICE
Jarawa (Andaman Islands)	Predict cyclones by observing fish movement & sea behaviour → timely evacuation
Khasi (Meghalaya)	Community agroforestry & sacred groves → preserve soil moisture & biodiversity in high-rainfall zones
Apatani (Arunachal Pradesh)	Rice-fish integrated farming in Ziro Valley → conserve water & enhance soil fertility without chemicals
Dongria Kondh (Odisha) & Irular (Tamil Nadu)	Organic multi-crop farming with traditional pest control & seed-saving → food & ecological security
Zabo System (Nagaland)	Combines rainwater harvesting + forestry + animal husbandry + agriculture → reduces drought stress

4.3 Policy Disconnect & Continuing Struggles

- CAMPA & Green India Mission: top-down → "**green displacement**" via afforestation without consent
- Gender inequalities widening: tribal women bear burden of resource collection
- Traditional rain forecasting & shifting cultivation failing as climate shifts become unpredictable
- Institutional fragmentation (**MoTA vs MoEFCC**); neglect of Gram Sabha consent under FRA

4.4 Path Ahead: Integrating Rights & Resilience

- Integrate **FRA (2006) & PESA (1996)** into climate-adaptation frameworks → link with **PM JANMAN**
- Empower **Gram Sabhas** to manage eco-restoration & climate funds locally
- Document & scale up **Zabo & Apatani systems** across eco-regions
- Strengthen role of **tribal women & PVTGs** in climate planning
- Blend **community forecasting** with modern satellite-based early-warning systems

Key Insight: The people who **nurture and protect** India's natural ecosystems are the ones **most endangered by climate change**. Building climate resilience must begin with strengthening the **rights, knowledge, and institutions** of forest-dwelling communities.

5. INDUSTRIALIZATION & URBANIZATION — IMPACT ON TRIBALS

INDUSTRIALIZATION & URBANIZATION

- **Cause:** Mineral-rich tribal lands → mining, projects, infrastructure
- **Process:** Land acquisition → meagre cash → landless & moneyless
- **Impact (4D):** Social | Economic | Religious | Psychological
- **Positive:** Education, healthcare, art recognition, social reform

HANDWRITTEN

Das and Banerji (1964)

Impact of industrialization & urbanization on tribals can be studied under **4 major dimensions** — social, economic, religious, and psychological — each reflecting deep structural changes in tribal society.

Core Problem: Despite rules providing **90% reservation for locals** in employment & training, **outsiders get preferential treatment**. Tribals become industrial/unskilled labour living in outskirts slums.

5.1 Case Studies — Industrialization

Pakri Barwadih Coal Mining

Hazaribagh, Jharkhand | NTPC

3,319 ha acquired; 19 villages displaced; 87,000+ ha total in Jharkhand (> Bengaluru). Skilled jobs to migrants; locals left landless.

Chaal Coal Mine

Raigarh, Chhattisgarh | SECL

400 Kavar families displaced from Lath; water contaminated; promises on paper only; Hindalco demolished homes without consent.

5.2 Case Study — Urbanization

Madhya Pradesh — Encroachment & Forest Loss

Shahdol District, MP | 2022

- MP has India's **largest tribal population (~15%)**: Western Belt (Bhil 49%) & Eastern Belt (Gond 36%)
- Leads country in **forest land encroachment: 5,347 sq km lost**
- **Dhyan Singh case (2022)**: Tribal man committed suicide after forest dept demolished his hut for "encroaching" on 0.010 ha — he had PMAY money to build that very house
- Dept justified under **Section 36(1) of Indian Forest Act, 1927**

5.3 Urbanization — Process & Problems

- Developmental projects → resettlement → **loss of forest access, land, livelihood**
- Tribals venture to nearest towns → **secluded culture meets cosmopolitan society** → identity crisis
- Forced to live in **filthy outskirts slums** without tap water, drainage, garbage disposal
- Initial unskilled jobs vanish after construction; skilled jobs taken by **outsiders who settle on tribal land**
- Tribals driven to fringes as **"rejects"**

5.4 Four-Dimensional Impact (Das & Banerji, 1964)

DIMENSION

KEY IMPACTS

1. SOCIAL	a) Loss of Home & Forests: MP lost 219.7 ha of forest to infra projects (24% of India's total diversion); sacred groves destroyed b) Resources Exploited, Tribals Left Behind: Keonjhar (Odisha) — rich in iron/manganese but 13L children stunted, 74.7% pregnant women anaemic, 25.9% women low BMI (NFHS-5) c) Family & Kinship Breakdown: Joint → nuclear families; elders lose authority; rise in divorces, inter-community marriages; decline in community festivals
2. ECONOMIC	a) Occupation Shift: Subsistence agriculture → individual wage labour; flexible communal work → rigid factory hours; labour shifts from collective social activity to individual economic necessity b) Unemployment: Skilled/semi-skilled jobs → non-tribal workers; tribals = temporary unskilled labourers; post-project: no income or land → migrate as construction workers, vendors, domestic helpers
3. RELIGIOUS	Rituals connected to agriculture/harvest/forest worship shortened or discontinued; financial hardship & lack of leisure; community shrines & sacred groves inaccessible after displacement; communal & spiritual identity eroded
4. PSYCHOLOGICAL	Deep insecurity & helplessness; independent cultivators → dependent on employers; low self-esteem, frustration, anxiety ; Das & Banerji: "emergence of a sense of powerlessness "; youth: identity crises & substance abuse vulnerability

5.5 Positive Impacts

AREA	POSITIVE OUTCOME
Education & Healthcare	Spread of education, healthcare & infrastructure in tribal regions
Social Reform	Declining acceptance of witch-hunting, child marriage, gender taboos
Art Recognition	Gond paintings (MP) & Warli art (MH) gained national/international recognition
Economic Empowerment	NGOs & SHGs help market handicrafts, forest produce & traditional goods

Conclusion: Industrialization & urbanization brought both development & destruction. The need: **inclusive, participatory development** where tribals are **partners, not victims**. Sustainable development must integrate economic growth with cultural preservation.

APPENDIX: ALL HANDWRITTEN (✎) ANNOTATIONS

#	SCHOLAR / NAME	CONTEXT & CONTRIBUTION	PAGE
1	Michael Cernea ✎	Involuntary displacement should be minimized/avoided; R&R must be "people centric"	Pg 3
2	Nalini Negi & Sutapa Ganguly ✎	Study for Univ. of Bielefeld (2011): 50M displaced, 40-50% tribals	Pg 3
3	Tripathi (2016) ✎	Tribes live in "harmonious & interdependent relationship" with forests	Pg 7
4	Hiremath (1994) ✎	Tribals should be actively involved in forest protection, regeneration & development (NFP 1988 context)	Pg 8
5	Das & Banerji (1964) ✎	4 dimensions of industrialization/urbanization impact: social, economic, religious, psychological	Pg 23

Source: Sarrthi IAS — Anthropology Foundation — Tribal India Handout 3 (L-62) | Nataraj Sir
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